JanGyan — Learn Without Limits

Category 3: Road Safety & Public Safety

Module 1 - Fundamentals of Road Safety

📋 Module Overview

This handbook is your complete, beginner-to-advanced guide to **Road Safety** — what it means, why it matters for every Indian citizen, and the practical knowledge that keeps you and your family safe on India's roads. Whether you are a student, a daily commuter, a two-wheeler rider, a parent, or a senior citizen, this handbook is written so that you can read it once and walk away confident, informed, and safer.

By the end of this module, you will not need to search anywhere else to understand the fundamentals of road safety in India.

🎯 Learning Objectives

After completing this module, you will be able to:

- Define road safety in simple, practical terms
- Explain why road safety is a national and personal priority in India
- Identify the major causes of road accidents
- Understand the responsibilities of every category of road user
- Recognise and practise safe road behaviour in daily life
- Interpret key official road safety statistics for India
- Understand the Vision Zero concept and its relevance to India
- Know the key traffic laws, penalties, and government schemes that protect citizens
- Respond correctly during and immediately after a road accident

🚦 Why This Topic Matters

India has one of the busiest and most diverse road networks in the world — pedestrians, cyclists, two-wheelers, cars, buses, and trucks often share the very same stretch of road. This mix, combined with rapid urbanisation and rising vehicle ownership, makes road safety one of India's most pressing public health challenges.

> **Reality Check:** According to the Ministry of Road Transport and Highways (MoRTH), India recorded **4,80,583 road accidents in 2023**, causing **1,72,890 deaths** — the highest ever recorded in a single year. That works out to a road accident death roughly every three minutes, around the clock.

Road safety is no longer a subject only for traffic police or transport officials. It is a **life skill** — similar to knowing how to swim or manage money responsibly. A single moment of carelessness — skipping a helmet, ignoring a red light, driving after a drink — can permanently change a family's future.

This is why JanGyan begins its Road Safety & Public Safety category with this foundational module.

📖 Introduction

Road Safety refers to the methods, laws, and everyday practices used to prevent road users from being killed or seriously injured, and to protect the wellbeing of everyone who uses the road — pedestrians, cyclists, motorcyclists, drivers, and passengers alike.

In simple words: road safety is about making sure that a road journey — however short or long — ends the way it began: **safely**.

Road safety is not the responsibility of one group alone. It is a shared system built on several pillars working together:

Pillar	Role
Road Users	Following rules, driving responsibly, using safety gear
Government & Enforcement	Making laws, building safe roads, enforcing traffic rules
Vehicle Manufacturers	Building vehicles that meet strong safety standards
Emergency & Medical Services	Responding quickly to save lives after a crash

A well-designed road is only as safe as the people who use it. Likewise, the strictest law is meaningless if it is not followed or enforced. Real road safety requires people, infrastructure, and enforcement to work together — not in isolation.

🧠 Fundamental Concepts

Before going deeper, let us understand a few foundational ideas that the rest of this module is built upon.

What Is Road Safety?

Road Safety — The set of practices, rules, designs, and systems intended to reduce the risk of death, injury, or damage on roads, and to protect everyone who travels on them.

The Safe System Approach

Modern road safety thinking worldwide — and increasingly in India — is built around the **Safe System** approach, which rests on a simple but powerful idea:

- Humans make mistakes, and no one should die because of an honest one
- Responsibility for safety is shared between road users **and** the people who design, build, and manage roads and vehicles
- The road system itself — not driver behaviour alone — should be designed so that a mistake does not turn fatal

Key Definitions

- **Road Accident** — An unplanned, unexpected event on a public road resulting in death, injury, or damage
- **Fatal Accident** — An accident in which one or more people lose their lives
- **Road User** — Any person using a public road: pedestrian, cyclist, rider, driver, or passenger
- **Traffic Violation** — Breaking any rule under the Motor Vehicles Act, such as overspeeding or signal jumping
- **Black Spot** — A specific stretch of road with a documented history of frequent or severe accidents

🚗 Complete Detailed Explanation

Part A — Causes of Road Accidents

Accident causes are usually grouped into four broad categories. Understanding them helps explain why the same mistake, repeated by millions of road users daily, adds up to such a large national toll.

Category	Common Examples	What the Data Shows
Human Error	Overspeeding, drunk driving, red-light jumping, wrong-side driving, mobile phone use, fatigue, no helmet/seatbelt	Overspeeding alone was linked to **68% of road accident deaths in 2023** (71.2% in 2022) — the single largest cause
Road Environment	Potholes, poor lighting, missing signage, encroachments, sharp or blind curves	Highways make up only ~5% of India's road network but account for over **53% of accidents and 59% of fatalities** (2023)
Vehicle-Related	Worn tyres, brake failure, poor maintenance, overloading	A frequent contributing factor, especially in commercial and heavy-vehicle crashes
Weather-Related	Fog, heavy rain, low visibility	Sharply increases stopping distance and reduces reaction time

Driving under the influence, red-light jumping, and mobile phone use — taken together — accounted for about **7.4% of accidents and 8.3% of deaths** nationally in 2022. Smaller than overspeeding, but still an entirely preventable share.

Part B — Road Users & Their Responsibilities

Every category of road user has specific, practical responsibilities:

- **Pedestrians:** Use footpaths and zebra crossings; use foot-over-bridges or subways where available; avoid jaywalking; never use a phone while crossing; make eye contact with drivers before stepping onto the road
- **Two-Wheeler Riders:** Wear an ISI-marked helmet — for the rider *and* pillion; never carry more than one pillion; hold a valid licence; avoid phone use; use indicators before turning
- **Car Drivers & Occupants:** Every occupant should wear a seatbelt; use a child restraint for young children; never use a phone while driving; maintain lane discipline; never drink and drive
- **Cyclists:** Use cycle lanes where available; wear reflective gear at night; use hand signals; ride in single file in traffic
- **Commercial/Heavy Vehicle Drivers:** Follow speed limits; take scheduled rest breaks; respect load limits; check blind spots; use fog lights and reflective tape
- **Passengers:** Wear seatbelts; never distract the driver; board and alight only at designated stops; never lean out of a moving vehicle

Part C — Safe Road Behaviour (Defensive Driving)

- Scan the road continuously — not just directly ahead
- Predict what other road users might do, especially pedestrians and two-wheelers
- Keep a safe following distance — the "three-second rule" is a simple, reliable guide
- Never assume the other person will follow the rule; drive defensively, not reactively
- Reduce speed near schools, markets, and residential areas
- Use indicators well before turning or changing lanes
- Avoid distractions — no phone calls, texting, or eating while driving

Part D — The Vision Zero Concept

Vision Zero — A road safety approach where preventing death and serious injury is treated as more important than any other objective of the transport system, including traffic speed or convenience.

Vision Zero began in Sweden in the 1990s, built on one central idea: **no loss of life on the road is acceptable**, and traffic deaths and serious injuries are preventable — not inevitable. Its core principles are:

- The road transport system should be designed so that a human mistake does not lead to death or serious injury
- Responsibility for safety is shared between road users and those who design, build, and manage roads and vehicles
- Speed management is central, because the chance of surviving a crash drops sharply as impact speed rises

Vision Zero in India: Haryana became the first Indian state to formally adopt a Vision Zero programme, launched in 2017 and initially covering ten districts before expanding statewide. Its early phase reported a meaningful decline in road fatalities, and Punjab and several other states and cities have since explored similar approaches. In February 2026, IIT Delhi hosted India's first National Road Safety Confluence, where the "New Delhi Road Safety Declaration" set a long-term national goal of **zero preventable road fatalities**, aligned with the UN Decade of Action for Road Safety 2021–2030.

📝 Important Terminologies

Term	Simple Meaning
Black Spot	A road stretch with a history of frequent or severe accidents
Defensive Driving	Driving in a way that anticipates and avoids potential hazards
Fatality Rate	Number of road deaths per 10,000 registered vehicles
Golden Hour	The first 60 minutes after a serious injury, when timely treatment greatly improves survival chances
Good Samaritan	A bystander who voluntarily helps an accident victim, protected by law from harassment
Hit-and-Run	An accident where the responsible driver flees the scene without stopping
Jaywalking	Crossing or walking on a road at a point or in a manner not permitted
Right of Way	The legal priority given to one road user to proceed before another
Road Safety Audit	A formal, systematic check of road design to identify and fix safety risks
Vision Zero	A safe-system approach aiming to eliminate all road deaths and serious injuries

🧭 Step-by-Step Understanding

How a Road Accident Typically Unfolds

1. **Trigger** — A risk factor appears: overspeeding, distraction, fatigue, or a road defect
2. **Reduced Reaction Time** — The road user has less time to notice and respond to danger
3. **Loss of Control or Collision** — A vehicle collides with another vehicle, object, or person
4. **Impact** — Severity depends heavily on speed, safety gear used, and vehicle design
5. **Aftermath** — Emergency response, medical treatment, and the legal process begin

Building Safe Road Habits, Step by Step

1. **Before you start:** Check your vehicle — brakes, tyres, lights, mirrors — and wear proper safety gear
2. **Before you move:** Check mirrors and blind spots; fasten your seatbelt or helmet strap
3. **While on the road:** Follow speed limits, maintain lane discipline, keep a safe following distance
4. **At intersections:** Slow down, look both ways, respect signals and right of way
5. **In an emergency:** Stay calm, move to safety if possible, call for help
6. **After any accident:** Prioritise medical help first, then follow reporting procedures

🇮🇳 Real-Life Indian Examples

- **Delhi's High Accident Toll:** Among Indian cities with over a million population, Delhi recorded the highest number of road accidents in 2022 (5,652) and remains the only such city with over 1,000 road accident deaths in a single year — a reminder that even well-developed urban roads carry high risk without disciplined behaviour.
- **Haryana's Vision Zero Programme:** Launched in 2017 as India's first state-level Vision Zero initiative, combining engineering fixes, enforcement, and awareness campaigns. Its early phase reported a measurable decline in fatalities — showing that a systems-based approach can work in the Indian context.
- **The "Golden Hour" Difference:** Supreme Court directions led to a nationwide cashless treatment scheme (notified in 2025) after recognising that fast medical access after a crash is often the difference between life and death — a reminder of why bystander action matters as much as government policy.
- **Highway Accident Concentration:** National data shows highways make up only around 5% of India's total road network but account for more than half of all accidents and fatalities — underlining why speed discipline on highways is especially critical.

💬 Practical Scenarios

Scenario 1: You are riding a two-wheeler and it suddenly starts raining heavily.
Slow down, increase your following distance, and switch on headlights — braking distance increases significantly on wet roads.

Scenario 2: You are driving and see a pedestrian trying to cross at an unmarked spot.

Slow down and let them cross safely — pedestrians are the most vulnerable road users, and a moment's patience prevents tragedy.

Scenario 3: You witness a road accident while driving past.
Stop safely, call 112 (or 108 for an ambulance), and help if you can — the Good Samaritan guidelines protect you from legal harassment for helping.

Scenario 4: You are on a highway and start feeling drowsy while driving.
Pull over at a safe location and rest — fatigue slows reaction time as much as alcohol does, and continuing to drive is highly dangerous.

Scenario 5: Your friend has been drinking and offers to drop you home.
Politely refuse and arrange alternate transport — never travel with a driver who has been drinking, regardless of the distance.

🏛 Government Rules / Guidelines

- **National Road Safety Month:** Observed every January by the Ministry of Road Transport and Highways (MoRTH) to raise public awareness; the 2026 edition (1–31 January) carried the theme *"Sadak Suraksha – Jeevan Raksha"* ("Road Safety, Life Safety").
- **Cashless Treatment Scheme for Road Accident Victims, 2025:** Notified under Section 162(2) of the Motor Vehicles Act, this scheme guarantees cashless emergency treatment of up to ₹1.5 lakh for the first seven days after an accident, at designated hospitals, for every victim regardless of nationality or insurance status.
- **Good Samaritan / "Rahveer" Scheme:** Protects and rewards citizens who help accident victims within the golden hour; a Good Samaritan cannot be forced to reveal personal details or face detention, and the ten most exemplary interventions are recognised each year with cash awards.
- **e-DAR (electronic Detailed Accident Report) Project:** A central digital repository recording standardised accident data across states to help identify accident patterns and high-risk locations.
- **Black Spot Rectification:** MoRTH has worked to identify and correct thousands of accident-prone stretches ("black spots") on national highways through engineering fixes.
- **Mandatory Road Safety Audits:** Required at the design, construction, and operational stages of all national highway projects.
- **Stricter Vehicle Safety Norms:** Including mandatory airbags and anti-lock braking systems (ABS), alongside electronic enforcement such as speed cameras and CCTV surveillance.

⚖ Laws & Policies

India's road safety framework rests primarily on the **Motor Vehicles Act, 1988**, substantially strengthened by the **Motor Vehicles (Amendment) Act, 2019**, which sharply increased penalties for unsafe behaviour.

KEY LEGAL PROVISIONS

Provision	What It Covers
Section 129	Compulsory helmet-wearing for riders and pillion riders on two-wheelers
Section 185	Drunk driving — blood alcohol above 30 mg per 100 ml of blood is an offence
Section 194	Overloading of vehicles
Section 194B	Not wearing a seatbelt
Section 199A	Special provisions for offences committed by juveniles (minors)

PENALTIES UNDER THE MOTOR VEHICLES (AMENDMENT) ACT, 2019

Offence	Penalty (Approximate)
No helmet	₹1,000 fine + 3-month licence disqualification
No seatbelt	₹1,000 fine
No driving licence	₹5,000 fine
No vehicle insurance	₹2,000 fine (first offence)
Dangerous / rash driving	Up to ₹5,000 fine
Drunk driving (first offence)	₹10,000 fine and/or up to 6 months imprisonment
Drunk driving (repeat, within 3 years)	₹15,000 fine and/or up to 2 years imprisonment
Signal jumping	₹1,000 – ₹5,000 fine
Overspeeding	₹1,000 – ₹4,000 fine (varies by vehicle category)
Allowing a juvenile to drive	Guardian/owner fined ₹25,000; vehicle registration may be cancelled

Compensation for accident victims was also increased sharply under the 2019 amendment: the minimum compensation for death rose to **₹2 lakh** (from ₹25,000), and for grievous injury to **₹50,000** (from ₹12,500).

Minimum driving age: 18 years for a car or geared two-wheeler; a limited licence for a gearless two-wheeler up to 50cc may be issued from age 16, without a pillion rider.

Note: State governments may adjust certain fine amounts within the framework set by the central Act, so exact figures can vary slightly by state.

📊 Important Statistics (India)

NATIONAL TREND — ROAD ACCIDENTS IN INDIA

Year	Accidents	Deaths	Injured
2021	4,12,432	1,53,972	—
2022	4,61,312	1,68,491	4,43,366
2023	4,80,583	1,72,890	4,62,825

Source: Ministry of Road Transport and Highways, "Road Accidents in India" — 2022 and 2023 reports.

KEY FACTS FROM THE 2022 & 2023 MORTH REPORTS

Indicator	Finding
Leading cause of fatalities	Overspeeding — 68% of deaths (2023); 71.2% (2022)
Most affected age group	18–45 years — around 66% of victims
Highest-risk road user category	Two-wheeler riders — 45% of deaths (2023), followed by pedestrians
Road type concentration	Highways (~5% of road network) — over 53% of accidents, 59% of fatalities (2023)
Riskiest time of day	6 PM – 9 PM — busiest accident window (20.4% of accidents, 2022)
Rural vs. urban deaths	About 68% rural, 32% urban (2022)
State with highest fatalities	Uttar Pradesh (2022 & 2023), followed by Tamil Nadu

✓ Best Practices

- Always wear a helmet (rider & pillion) or seatbelt (driver & every passenger)
- Follow posted speed limits, especially near schools, markets, and residential zones
- Never drive or ride after consuming alcohol or drugs
- Keep a safe following distance from the vehicle ahead
- Use indicators before turning or changing lanes
- Keep your vehicle regularly serviced — brakes, tyres, and lights
- Avoid using a mobile phone while driving or riding
- Cross roads only at zebra crossings, subways, or foot-over-bridges

✕ Common Mistakes

- Riding without a helmet "just for a short distance"
- Assuming a seatbelt is unnecessary in the back seat
- Overtaking from the wrong side or on blind curves
- Driving while fatigued, especially on long highway trips
- Ignoring red lights when the road "looks empty"
- Letting children sit in the front seat or ride a two-wheeler unprotected
- Checking a phone message "just for a second" while driving

🔍 Myths vs Facts

Myth	Fact
"Wearing a seatbelt in the back seat isn't necessary"	Unbelted rear passengers can be thrown forward with great force, injuring themselves and front-seat occupants too
"I can handle driving after one or two drinks"	Even small amounts of alcohol slow reaction time and impair judgment — the legal limit exists because risk rises sharply beyond it
"Helmets are only needed on highways, not in the city"	Most fatal two-wheeler accidents in India happen within city and residential areas, not only on highways
"If I drive carefully, accidents won't happen to me"	Many victims are careful road users hit by someone else's mistake — defensive driving reduces, but cannot eliminate, that risk
"Bystanders can get into legal trouble for helping accident victims"	The Good Samaritan guidelines specifically protect citizens who help victims from legal harassment
"Speeding saves meaningful time on short city trips"	Over short distances, higher speed usually saves only a few minutes but dramatically increases crash severity

📌 Do's and Don'ts

Do	Don't
Wear a helmet/seatbelt on every single trip	Don't skip safety gear for "just a short distance"
Follow lane discipline and use indicators	Don't weave between lanes without signalling
Keep a safe following distance	Don't tailgate the vehicle ahead
Slow down near schools, markets, and turns	Don't assume the road ahead is always clear
Pull over if you feel drowsy or unwell	Don't push through fatigue to "reach faster"
Help accident victims and call for medical aid	Don't leave the scene without ensuring help is on the way

🛡 Safety Tips

For Pedestrians

- Use footpaths and designated crossings wherever available
- Look both ways before crossing, even on one-way roads
- Avoid using headphones or a phone while crossing

For Two-Wheeler Riders

- Always wear an ISI-marked helmet, properly fastened
- Never carry more than one pillion rider
- Use reflective gear when riding at night

For Car Drivers

- Ensure every occupant wears a seatbelt before starting the vehicle
- Use a child safety seat for young children
- Keep headlights, wipers, and mirrors in good working condition

For Children & Schools

- Teach children to cross only at marked crossings, with an adult
- Ensure school transport follows safety norms — seatbelts, speed limits, trained drivers

For Senior Citizens

- Cross at a comfortable pace, using pedestrian signals or foot-over-bridges where available
- Wear bright or reflective clothing when walking near roads, especially at dusk

👜 Practical Checklist

- [ ] Vehicle documents (licence, RC, insurance, PUC) are valid and carried
- [ ] Helmet/seatbelt worn correctly before starting the journey
- [ ] Brakes, tyres, lights, and mirrors checked before a long trip
- [ ] Mobile phone kept away or on silent while driving
- [ ] Route and weather conditions checked in advance for long journeys
- [ ] Emergency numbers (112, 108) saved in your phone
- [ ] No alcohol or drugs consumed before driving
- [ ] Children secured with appropriate restraints

🎓 Quick Revision Notes

- Road safety = practices, laws, and systems that prevent death/injury on roads
- Safe System approach = humans make mistakes; the system should prevent those mistakes from becoming fatal
- Overspeeding is the single largest cause of road deaths in India (~68% in 2023)
- Two-wheeler riders are the most affected road-user group (45% of deaths, 2023)
- Legal blood alcohol limit for driving in India: 30 mg per 100 ml of blood (Section 185, MV Act)
- Golden Hour = first 60 minutes after injury; the Good Samaritan law protects those who help
- Vision Zero = a philosophy aiming for zero traffic deaths, pioneered in Sweden, first adopted in India by Haryana (2017)
- National Road Safety Month is observed every January by MoRTH

🎯 Key Takeaways

1. Road safety is a shared responsibility between road users, the government, and vehicle makers
2. Most road accidents in India stem from preventable human error — overspeeding above all
3. Safety gear (helmet, seatbelt) is the single most effective personal protection available
4. Emergency response within the "golden hour" saves lives — and the law protects those who help
5. India's laws (Motor Vehicles Act, 1988, as amended in 2019) impose serious penalties for unsafe behaviour
6. Vision Zero shows that with the right systems, road deaths are preventable — not inevitable

📖 Glossary

- **Black Spot** — A road stretch with a history of frequent or severe accidents
- **Defensive Driving** — Driving in a way that anticipates and avoids hazards before they occur
- **Fatality Rate** — Number of road deaths per 10,000 registered vehicles
- **Golden Hour** — The first 60 minutes after a serious injury, critical for survival
- **Good Samaritan** — A bystander who helps an accident victim, protected by law
- **Hit-and-Run** — Fleeing an accident scene without stopping to help or report
- **Jaywalking** — Crossing a road at a point or in a manner not permitted
- **Right of Way** — Legal priority for one road user to proceed before another
- **Road Safety Audit** — A formal review of road design to identify safety risks
- **Safe System Approach** — A philosophy where system design prevents human errors from becoming fatal
- **Vision Zero** — A safe-system approach aiming to eliminate road deaths and serious injuries

? Frequently Asked Questions

1. What is road safety in simple words?

It means following rules, using safety gear, and behaving responsibly so that every road journey ends without death or injury.

2. Is road safety only about following traffic rules?

No. It also includes safe road design, vehicle safety standards, and quick emergency response — not just driver behaviour.

3. What is the single biggest cause of road accidents in India?

Overspeeding, which was linked to about 68% of road accident deaths in 2023, according to MoRTH.

4. Which road users are most at risk in India?

Two-wheeler riders, who accounted for the largest share of road accident deaths (45%) in 2023, followed by pedestrians.

5. Is it compulsory to wear a helmet in India?

Yes. Under Section 129 of the Motor Vehicles Act, wearing a helmet is compulsory for both the rider and the pillion passenger on a two-wheeler.

6. What is the legal alcohol limit for driving in India?

30 mg of alcohol per 100 ml of blood, under Section 185 of the Motor Vehicles Act.

7. What is the minimum age to get a driving licence in India?

18 years for a car or geared two-wheeler; a limited licence for a gearless two-wheeler up to 50cc may be issued from age 16.

8. What should I do immediately after witnessing a road accident?

Ensure your own safety first, then call 112 or 108, and help the victim reach medical care if it is safe to do so.

9. What is the "golden hour"?

The first 60 minutes after a serious injury, when prompt medical treatment significantly improves the chance of survival.

10. Can I get into legal trouble for helping an accident victim?

No. The Good Samaritan guidelines protect anyone who helps a victim from legal harassment, and they cannot be forced to reveal personal details unless they choose to.

11. What is the Cashless Treatment Scheme for road accident victims?

A 2025 scheme guaranteeing free treatment of up to ₹1.5 lakh for the first seven days after a road accident, at designated hospitals, for every victim.

12. What is Vision Zero?

A road safety philosophy holding that no traffic death is acceptable, and that the road system should be designed to prevent human mistakes from turning fatal.

13. Which Indian state first adopted the Vision Zero approach?

Haryana, which launched its Vision Zero programme in 2017.

14. What is a "black spot" on a road?

A specific stretch of road with a history of frequent or severe accidents, often targeted for engineering improvements.

15. What is the penalty for not wearing a seatbelt in India?

A fine of ₹1,000 under the Motor Vehicles (Amendment) Act, 2019.

16. What is the penalty for drunk driving in India?

₹10,000 and/or up to 6 months imprisonment for a first offence, rising to ₹15,000 and/or up to 2 years for a repeat offence within 3 years.

17. Why are highways so accident-prone despite being well-built?

Higher speeds on highways increase crash severity; MoRTH data shows highways account for a disproportionately large share of accidents and deaths relative to their length.

18. What is the Safe System approach to road safety?

An approach that assumes humans will sometimes make mistakes, and designs roads, vehicles, and speeds so those mistakes don't result in death or serious injury.

19. When is National Road Safety Month observed in India?

Every January, led by the Ministry of Road Transport and Highways; the 2026 theme was "Sadak Suraksha – Jeevan Raksha."

20. Is it safe for children to ride on a two-wheeler without protection?

No. Riding without proper protection or restraint, especially for young children, is unsafe and should always be avoided.

21. What is defensive driving?

A driving approach that involves constantly scanning for hazards, predicting the actions of others, and keeping a safety margin — rather than assuming other road users will always follow the rules.

22. Where can I find official road accident data for India?

On the Ministry of Road Transport and Highways' official website (morth.nic.in), which publishes the annual "Road Accidents in India" report.

🖼 Suggested Infographics, Flowcharts & Illustrations

(For the JanGyan design team — placement suggestions only; no images generated here)

- **Safe System Approach diagram** → after "Fundamental Concepts"
- **Flowchart: "What to Do After a Road Accident"** → after "Step-by-Step Understanding"
- **Road user responsibility icon gallery** (pedestrian, rider, driver, cyclist icons) → within "Complete Detailed Explanation"
- **India road accident statistics infographic** (2021–2023 trend bar chart) → within "Important Statistics"
- **Helmet & seatbelt correct-usage illustration** → within "Safety Tips"
- **Do's and Don'ts visual card** → after the Do's and Don'ts table

🖷 Official References

- Ministry of Road Transport and Highways (MoRTH), Government of India — "Road Accidents in India" annual reports (2022 and 2023 editions)
- Press Information Bureau (PIB), Government of India — releases on MoRTH road safety initiatives and schemes
- Motor Vehicles Act, 1988, and Motor Vehicles (Amendment) Act, 2019 — India Code portal
- United Nations — Decade of Action for Road Safety 2021–2030, and the associated Global Plan
- World Health Organization (WHO) — Road Safety programme and the Decade of Action
- Supreme Court of India — directions in S. Rajaseekaran vs. Union of India on the golden-hour cashless treatment scheme

🔗 Official Government Website Links

- Ministry of Road Transport & Highways: **https://morth.nic.in**
- Road Accidents in India Reports: **https://morth.nic.in/road-accident-in-india**
- Parivahan Sewa (licences & vehicle records): **https://parivahan.gov.in**
- Press Information Bureau: **https://pib.gov.in**
- National Highways Authority of India: **https://nhai.gov.in**
- iRAD — Integrated Road Accident Database: **https://irad.gov.in**

Emergency Numbers: All-in-one Police/Ambulance/Fire: **112** · Ambulance: **108**

🏁 Conclusion

Road safety is not about fear — it is about awareness and discipline. The vast majority of road accidents in India are preventable, and most begin with a single avoidable decision: a skipped helmet, a few extra kilometres per hour, one drink before driving. By understanding what road safety means, recognising the real causes of accidents, and knowing your responsibilities as a road user, you have already taken the most important step toward protecting yourself, your family, and your community.

This is only the beginning of your Road Safety journey with JanGyan. Stay alert, stay disciplined, and remember: **every rule you follow is a life you protect — possibly your own.**

JanGyan — Learn Without Limits
Module 1 of the Road Safety & Public Safety Category